several of them in upcoming chapters, classes are one well-known technique for managing objects. CoffeeScript has dedicated syntax for creating and using classes on top of the underlying prototype-based object system.

The `clear` method on views is a potential initialization step you may want to do for many objects. The underlying JavaScript uses a constructor function for this purpose. When used with the `new` keyword, a constructor function creates and initializes an object in JavaScript:

```
function Views () {
  this.pages = {};
}
businessViews = new Views();
```

Unfortunately, constructor functions in JavaScript are awkward and confusing. Regardless, if you're creating many of the same sorts of objects, you'll want three features: a simple declarative syntax for defining them, a way to specify a constructor function for initialization, and optimized performance when creating a large number of objects. That's what classes in CoffeeScript give you.

In this section you'll see how to use this syntax to declare classes. You'll also see that objects aren't equal, regardless of whether they were created from the same class. First, how do you declare a class?

4.8.1. Declaration

CoffeeScript provides a class syntax that cleans up some of the awkwardness in JavaScript constructors and handles setting up links to prototype objects. If you were writing a system that was capturing the views for many different sites and wanted to define a class for views, it could be implemented as shown in the following listing.

Listing 4.8. A page views class